

Special Points Decoder

The 15 Collaterals — Luo-Connecting Points, in Full

Standalone reference — pairs with the Week 8 Study Guide

This Decoder Covers:

- All 15 Luo-Connecting Points, in full — the star special-point category this week
- The “why 15, not 12” structural logic, and the front/back/side coverage principle
- Special-point identity overlaps — points that are BOTH a Luo point AND a Confluent point
- A/B/C tiered cumulative recap of every other special-point category (Yuan-Source through Crossing Points), rolled forward from the Week 6 pilot

The Luo-Connecting point IS the special-point content for this week -- no new organ-based categories (Yuan-Source, He-Sea, etc.) are introduced. GB/LR Luo points are self-study slide content, flagged accordingly below.

The 15 Luo-Connecting Points (Luo Mai)

This week's star category

The 12 Primary Meridians and the Conception and Governor Vessels each give off a collateral branch, totaling fifteen when combined with the Major (Great) Collateral of the Spleen -- collectively the “15 Collaterals” (Luo Mai). Each is named after the acupoint from which it originates -- its Luo-Connecting point.

Function: the Luo-Connecting point's job is to link (n, Luo = “net/connect”) each meridian to its interior-exteriorly paired partner, strengthening their shared function and treating disorders that involve both. Distinguish from a Yuan-Source point (treats disorders of its OWN meridian) and from a Confluent point (opens an Extraordinary Vessel). One acupoint can carry more than one of these special-point identities at once (e.g. LU 7 is both Luo point AND CV's Confluent point) -- when a point carries multiple special functions, its clinical reach is broader/stronger.

MERIDIAN	LUO POINT	CONNECTS TO
Lung (LU)	LU 7 Lieque	Large Intestine
Large Intestine (LI)	LI 6 Pianli	Lung
Stomach (ST)	ST 40 Fenglong	Spleen
Spleen (SP)	SP 4 Gongsun	Stomach
Heart (HT)	HT 5 Tongli	Small Intestine
Small Intestine (SI)	SI 7 Zhizheng	Heart
Bladder (BL)	BL 58 Feiyang	Kidney
Kidney (KI)	KI 4 Dazhong	Bladder
Pericardium (PC)	PC 6 Neiguan	Sanjiao (Triple Energizer)
Sanjiao (SJ)	SJ 5 Waiguan	Pericardium
Gallbladder (GB)	GB 37 Guangming	Liver [self-study]
Liver (LR)	LR 5 Ligou	Gallbladder [self-study]
Collateral of the Conception Vessel (Ren Mai)		CV 15 Jiuwei
Collateral of the Governor Vessel (Du Mai)		GV 1 Changqiang
Great (Major) Collateral of the Spleen		SP 21 Dabao

[self-study] = GB/LR collaterals were slide-deck content Dr. Zhang did not reach live.

Why 15, Not 12? -- The Structural Logic

Why 15, not 12? The 12 paired meridians (6 yin-yang pairs) each need a Luo-Connecting point to link them -- that's 12. But the 12 primary meridians don't have their own acupoints EVERYWHERE harmony is needed: two extra vessels (Du Mai/GV and Ren Mai/CV) have their own dedicated points, so they each need their own collateral too -- that's 14. And there is one region no collateral yet covers: the LATERAL side of the chest (CV covers front, GV covers back, but nothing covers the side). The Spleen's Great Collateral (Dabao, SP 21) fills that gap -- bringing the total to 15.

Full course detail for each of the 3 “extra” collaterals:

Collateral of the Conception Vessel (Ren Mai) -- CV 15 Jiuwei

Separates from the Governor Vessel at the lower end of the sternum; from Jiuwei (CV 15) it spreads over the abdomen.

Why it exists: Covers the FRONT midline -- balances the GV collateral on the back midline.

Collateral of the Governor Vessel (Du Mai) -- GV 1 Changqiang

Arises from Changqiang (GV 1) in the perineum; runs upward along both sides of the spine to the nape and spreads over the top of the head. At the scapular region it connects with the Bladder meridian and pierces through the spine.

Why it exists: Covers the BACK midline -- balances the CV collateral on the front midline.

Great (Major) Collateral of the Spleen -- SP 21 Dabao

Begins from Dabao (SP 21), emerges 3 cun below Yuanye (GB 22), and spreads through the chest and hypochondriac (lateral costal) region, gathering the blood all over the body.

Why it exists: Covers the LATERAL side of the chest -- the one area the 12 paired-meridian collaterals leave uncovered. This is WHY there are 15 collaterals, not 12: the body needs front (CV), back (GV), AND lateral (Spleen Great Luo) coverage to stay in harmony.

MEMORY AID

The 12 paired-meridian Luo points all sit on the LIMBS (wrist for Hand meridians, ankle for Foot meridians). The 3 extra Luo points are the exception -- all three sit on the TRUNK (sternum, perineum, lateral chest), because their entire purpose is to cover trunk surface area no limb-based point could reach.

Special-Point Identity Overlaps

Points that carry more than one function

Some acupoints carry more than one special-point identity at once. Below: every Luo-Connecting point that ALSO serves as the Confluent (opening) point of an Extraordinary Vessel -- all four were reviewed in Week 7 and recur here as the clearest examples of this principle. A point with multiple special-point identities has a broader, stronger clinical reach than a single-purpose point.

LU 7 Lieque

As Luo point: Luo-Connecting point of Lung

Also: Confluent (opening) point of Ren Mai (CV)

Cough, sore throat, chest tightness (Luo function) + regulates all yin meridians via Ren Mai (Confluent function).

SP 4 Gongsun

As Luo point: Luo-Connecting point of Spleen

Also: Confluent (opening) point of Chong Mai

Digestive/abdominal disorders (Luo function) + Sea-of-Blood/12-meridian regulation via Chong Mai (Confluent function).

PC 6 Neiguan

As Luo point: Luo-Connecting point of Pericardium

Also: Confluent (opening) point of Yin Wei Mai

Chest/heart symptoms (Luo function) + dominates the interior, links all yin meridians via Yin Wei Mai (Confluent function).

SJ 5 Waiguan

As Luo point: Luo-Connecting point of Sanjiao

Also: Confluent (opening) point of Yang Wei Mai

Exterior/febrile symptoms (Luo function) + dominates the exterior, links all yang meridians via Yang Wei Mai (Confluent function).

Cumulative Recap — All Other Special-Point Categories Tiered A/B/C, per the Week 6 pilot

No organ-based special-point categories are newly introduced this week (Week 8's own content is the Luo-Connecting points above). The categories below stay exactly as covered previously -- listed here for cumulative review, with the A/B/C exam-priority tiering piloted in the Week 6 Decoder, rolled forward as planned.

Tier key: A = high-yield, drill to automaticity. B = know the definition + 1 example cold. C = recognize the name and general function only.

A	YUAN-SOURCE Where the Source (Yuan) Qi is accessed. <i>Last new examples: Week 6 (PC7, SJ4, GB40, LR3)</i>
A	LUO-CONNECTING Where a Luo-vessel branches to the paired channel. <i>THIS WEEK -- see full treatment above.</i>
A	HE-SEA At elbow/knee; treats counterflow Qi and organ-level disorders. <i>Last new examples: Week 6 (PC3, SJ10, GB34, LR8)</i>
B	XI-CLEFT Cleft point for acute conditions/pain. <i>Last new examples: Week 6 (PC4, SJ7, GB36, LR6)</i>
B	FRONT-MU Where a zang/fu organ's Qi gathers anteriorly. <i>Last new examples: Week 6 (CV17, CV5, GB24, LR14)</i>
B	BACK-SHU Bladder-channel transport points for each organ. <i>Last new examples: Week 6 (BL14, BL22, BL19, BL18)</i>
B	CONFLUENT (OPENING) POINTS Access point for each Extraordinary Vessel. <i>Full treatment: Week 7 Decoder (all 4 master-couple pairs)</i>
C	HUI-MEETING (INFLUENTIAL) 8 points, meeting place for a tissue/substance category. <i>Last new examples: Week 6 (GB34 = Sinews; LR13 = Zang)</i>
C	JING-WELL / YING-SPRING / SHU-STREAM / JING-RIVER The Five-Shu points along each channel. <i>Last new examples: Week 6</i>
C	LOWER HE-SEA Special He-Sea points for the 6 Fu organs, on the leg. <i>Last new examples: Week 6 (SJ's is BL39, off-channel)</i>
C	COALESCENT POINTS (JIAO HUI XUE) Meeting points between an Extraordinary Vessel and a primary meridian. <i>Full treatment: Week 7 Decoder</i>
C	CROSSING POINTS A point crossed by more than one channel's pathway. <i>GB count still flagged/unresolved (Week 6)</i>